

# Phase 3 Visual Tightening Report

## Darts & Pats: subtraction and clarity pass

This pass reduces simultaneous controls and decoration so each screen has one dominant interaction: enter the exhibit, walk the Memory Corridor, follow strings, open the drawer, or play the Editor table.

|                                        |     |
|----------------------------------------|-----|
| Total archive records                  | 616 |
| Playable Editor cards after masking    | 616 |
| Withheld from Editor game              | 0   |
| Cards with form words masked           | 595 |
| Cards already playable without masking | 21  |

## What Was Simplified

The pass removes the permanent year dial, collapses seven rail stops into six, merges trouble spots back into the Memory Corridor, trims visible wall cards, quiets the Word Breeze, and reduces borders, dashed outlines, heavy shadows, gold accents, and all-caps noise.

## Memory Rail

The rail is now a narrow physical navigation object. Stops are Threshold, Memory Corridor, Follow the Strings, Open the Drawer, Editor's Table, and Reflection Wall, plus a compact Class-of tab. Active tabs still pull forward, but the rail no longer reads as a side control panel.

## Class Of Picker

The always-visible year picker became a pullout tray. A visitor chooses a class year and applies a four-year window, so Class of 2004 means 2001, 2002, 2003, and 2004. After choosing, the tray closes and the active window appears as a chip near the corridor heading. Start over and idle reset clear it.

## Memory Corridor

The corridor now behaves more like a stage: walls show only a few supporting cards, the center carries the current mood sentence, three stats, up to four featured cards, and a clear route to the full drawer. Topic stations and the timeline remain tactile but less dominant.

## Editor Table Masking

The Editor game now starts from text\_full, masks whole-word dart, darts, pat, and pats as [form hidden], and only withholds a card if the masked version becomes too short, over-masked, or confusing. In this dataset all 616 cards remain playable, with 595 needing masking and 21 already safe.

## Avoiding StoryMap Conventions

The exhibit avoids numbered chapter dots, map-first scrollytelling, corporate content blocks, and dashboard rows. Navigation stays tactile: a rail, a Class-of ticket tray, floor tiles, wall cards, corkboard strings, a drawer, and an editor desk.

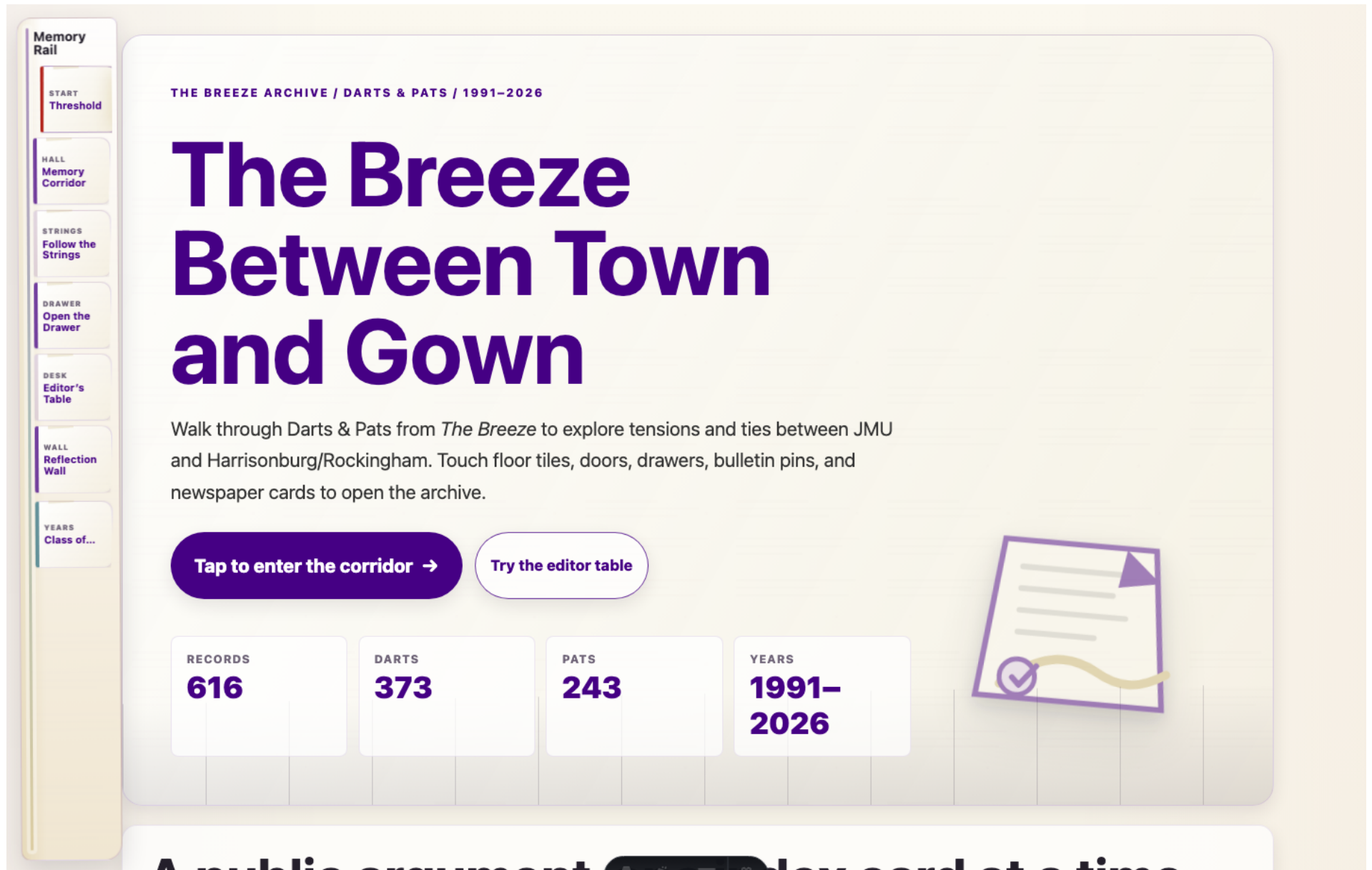
## Next Steps

Test the tightened version on the actual 16:9 kiosk, tune the corridor scroll position for first entry, decide whether the now-smaller asset list should be generated, and run a short public-touch rehearsal for idle reset, Class-of discovery, and drawer readability.

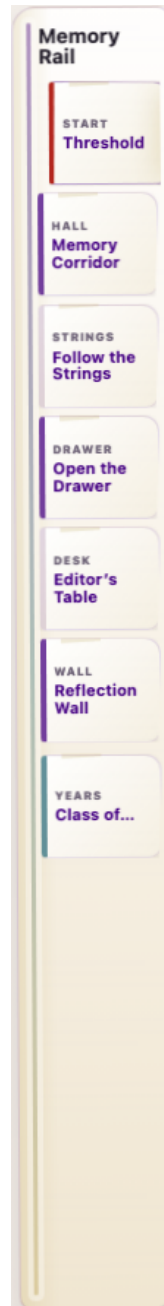
# Screenshot Evidence

Screenshots are also saved at [public/reports/screenshots/phase-3-visual-tightening](#).

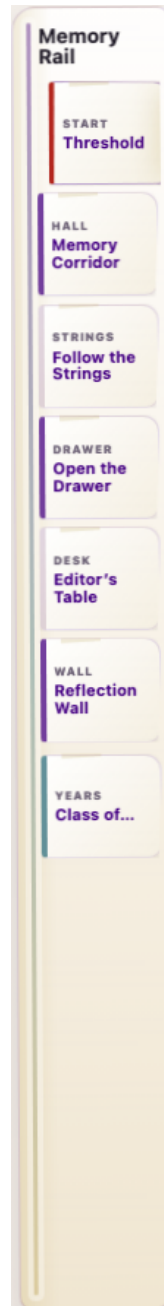
Simplified threshold with the slimmer Memory Rail visible.



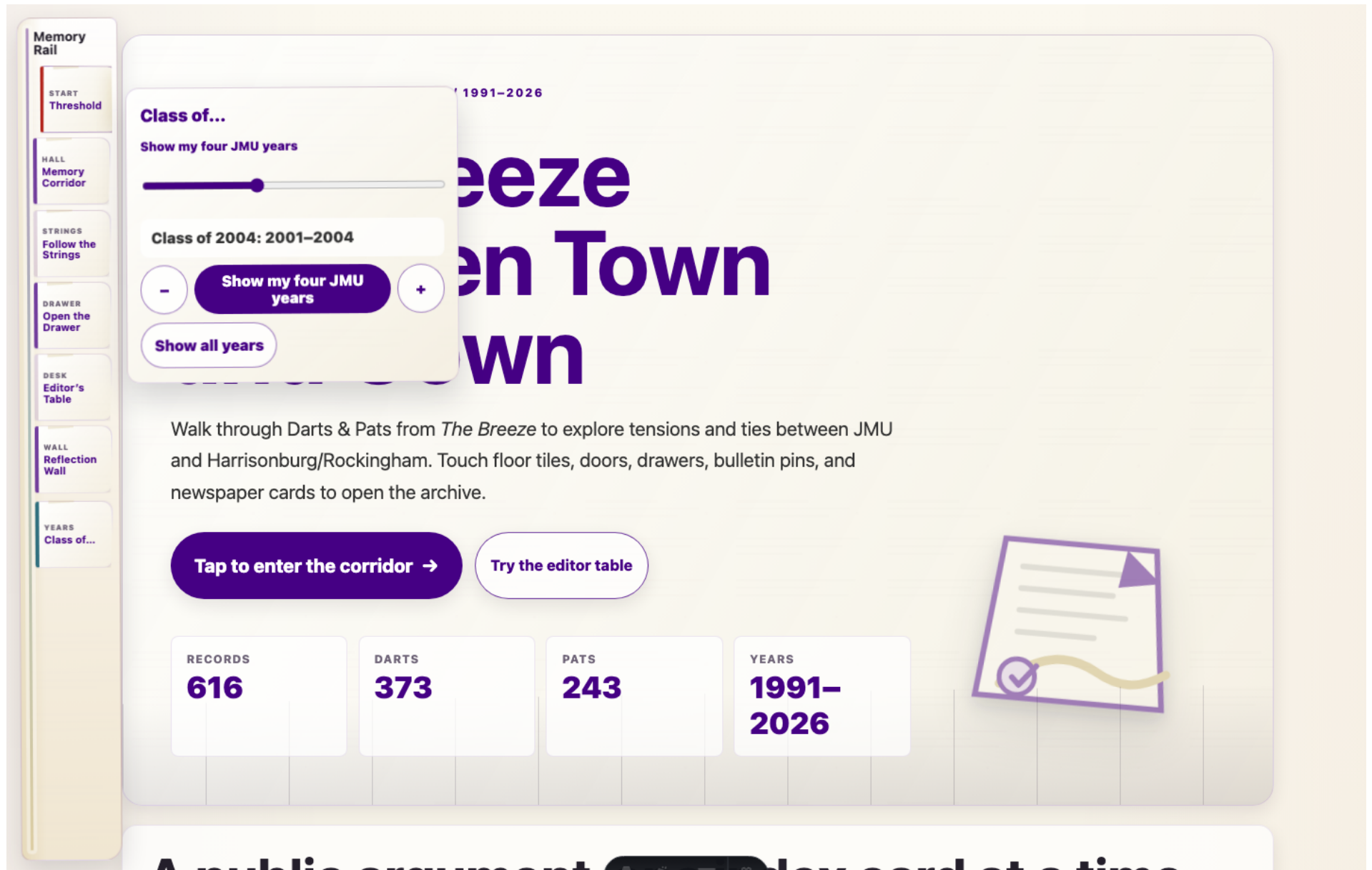
Simplified six-stop Memory Rail plus compact Class-of tab.



Class-of tray closed: the rail is a navigation object, not a control panel.



Class-of pullout tray open with the four-year explanation and show-all-years escape hatch.



Active Class of memory window shown as a chip near the corridor heading.

2.5D CORRIDOR

# The Memory Corridor

A quieter hallway of floor years, wall cards, and civic friction.

Class of 2004: 2001–2004

The archive is whispering about...

LifeStudentApartmentHousingLandlordsSentBehaviorNeighborsPartiesSafety

CURRENT VIEW

## Class of 2004: 2001–2004

The hallway is mixed: 40 sharp notes, 32 warm notes, 72 openable cards.

72CARDS

56%DARTS

44%PATs

DARTOCT 4, 2001

Housing, landlords & apartment life

A "have-you-no-conscience" dart to the selfish jerks who walked into our apartment on Monday and stole the \$150 w...  
our party Friday night t...

DARTJAN 25, 2001

Neighbors, parties & student behavior

A "could-you-be-any-more-stupid?" dart to the drunk yelling, "Hey security guard, come arrest me, I'm 19 and drunk!  
the Commons Apartments F...

Open the full drawer

MAILBOX WALL

Housing, landlords & apartment life

148 RECORDS · 113 D / 35 P

CROSSWALK

Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

96 RECORDS · 76 D / 20 P

PORCH LIGHT

Neighbors, parties & student behavior

72 RECORDS · 53 D / 19 P

VOLUNTARY

Community service & mutual aid

62 RECORDS · 41 D / 21 P

TIMELINE FLOOR

Step across yearly tiles. Darker means more Darts, warmer means more Pats, split tiles mean the town-gown mood could not pick a lane.

1991199219931994199519961997199819992000200120022003200420052006

Pats wall

PATAPR 2, 2001

Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

A "thanks-for-going-out-of-your-way" pat to Sgt. Anderson of the JMU Police for being...

PATAPR 23, 2001

Parking, towing & cars

A "thanks-for-saving-my-inebriated-butt-sanity-and-car" pat to the two awesome...

PATFEB 25, 2002

Community service & mutual aid

A "thank you" pat to Delta Gamma and Kappa Pi for the huge box of art supplies they...

PATNOV 11, 2004

Neighbors, parties & student behavior

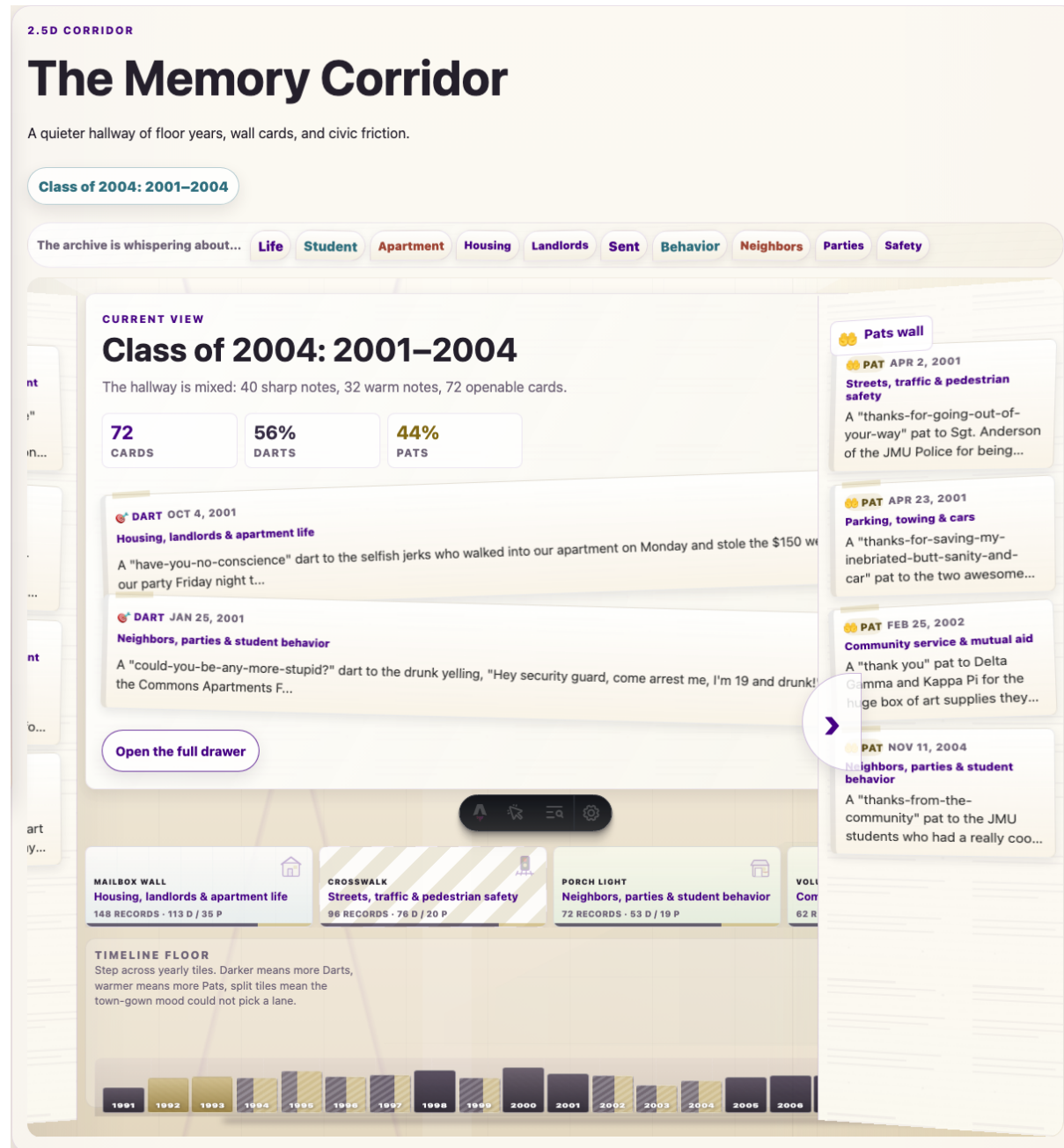
A "thanks-from-the-community" pat to the JMU students who had a really coo...

Darts & Pats Phase 3 Visual Tightening

Page 8



Simplified Memory Corridor stage with fewer visible cards, three stats, and one main drawer path.



Quiet Word Breeze strip with ten or fewer terms.

The archive is whispering about...

Life

Student

Apartment

Housing

Landlords

Sent

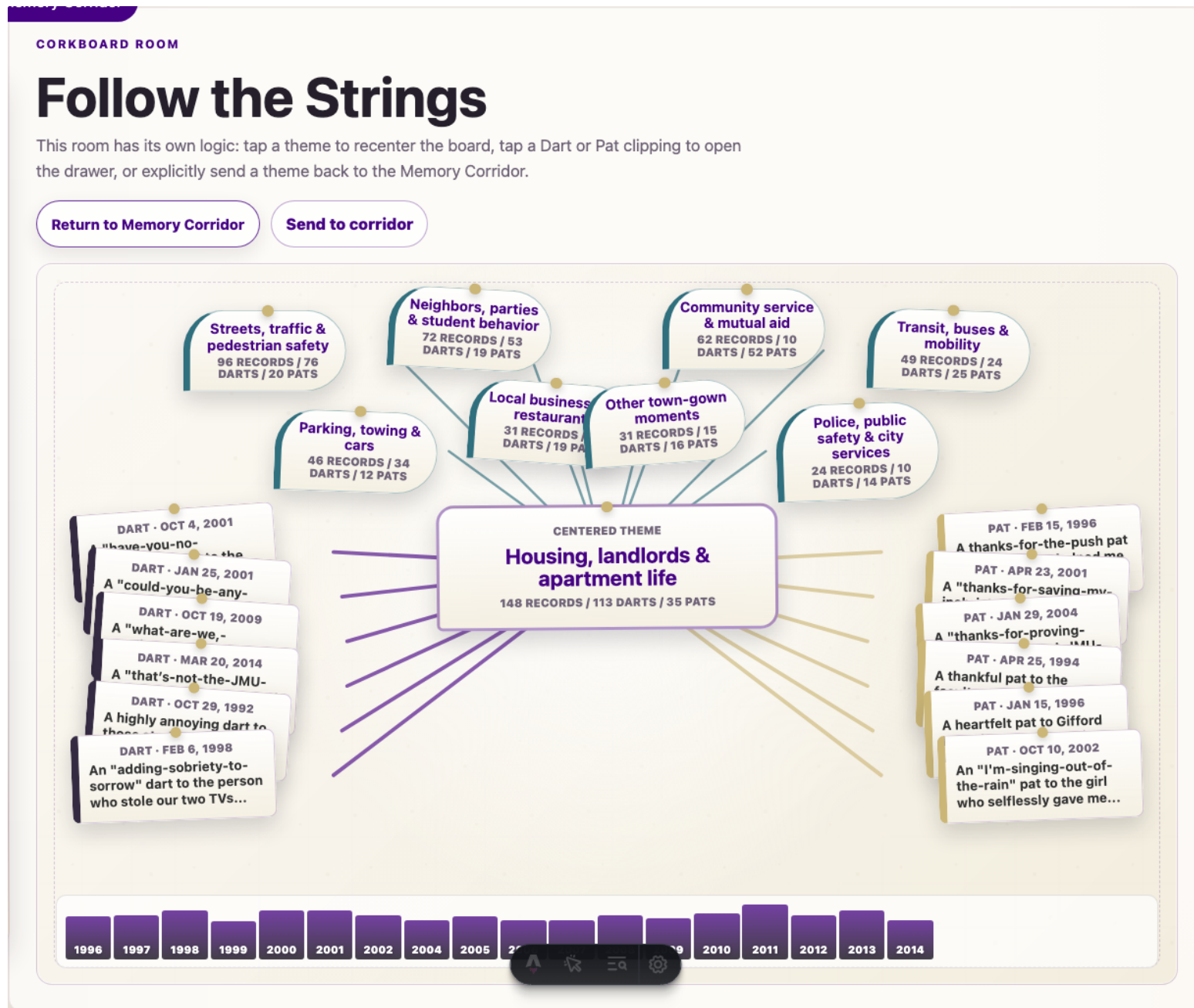
Behavior

Neighbors

Parties

Safety

Follow the Strings remains self-contained; sending to the corridor is secondary.



NO-SCORE INTERPRETIVE GAME

# You be the Breeze editor

Read a hidden card, guess whether it was a Dart or Pat, then reveal how it appeared and where it fits in the exhibit.

Some cards are held out or masked because they give away their own form.

**A "surprises-in-the-rain-are-not-welcomed" [form hidden] to the City of Harrisonburg for closing down South Main Street without notifying residents. From a now-soaked senior who enjoys watching bikes go in a circle, but would have preferred to drive instead of walk through the rain.**

FORM

Dart

Pat

Reveal the archive card

New card

TOPIC

Choose a topic



Choose a form and a topic. No points. Just interpretation with ink on its fingers.

Editor Table reveal state restores the original text and classification.

NO-SCORE INTERPRETIVE GAME

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A "surprises-in-the-rain-are-not-welcomed" dart to the City of Harrisonburg for closing down South Main Street without notifying residents. From a now-soaked senior who enjoys watching bikes go in a circle, but would have preferred to drive instead of walk through the rain.

FORM

Dart

Pat

TOPIC

Housing, landlords & apartment life - 113 D / 35 P

Reveal the archive card

New card

You matched the published form, and your topic guess belongs in the same hallway station. It appeared as a DART on Apr 27, 2006, tagged as Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety. [Open this card](#)

After the reveal: same topic

DART · MAR 27, 2006

**Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety**

An "are-you-trying-to-kill-us?" dart to the crosswalk button on Port Republic Road that doesn't...

DART · APR 6, 2006

**Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety**

A "remove-head-from-sphincter-then-drive" dart to the person driving the wrong way down S. Main...

After the reveal: same year

PAT · FEB 9, 2006

**Neighbors, parties & student behavior**

A "thanks-for-putting-things-in-perspective" pat to my neighbors who decided to throw rocks at ...

PAT · APR 3, 2006

**Downtown, arts & events**

A "thank-you-from-the-bottom-of-my-change-drawer" pat to the City of Harrisonburg for removing ...

PAT · APR 17, 2006

**Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety**

A "joy-comes-in-small-packages" pat to the JMU community for their help in the search for my Ch...

PAT · APR 17, 2006

**Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety**

A "joy-comes-in-small-packages" pat to the JMU community for their help in the search for my Ch...





Open Drawer remains the full archive browsing surface.

## READING DRAWER

# Open the Drawer

Every card opens into the original text. The exhibit works best when the data visualization sends people back to the words.

 **DART** OCT 4, 2001

### Housing, landlords & apartment life

A "have-you-no-conscience" dart to the selfish jerks who walked into our apartment on Monday and stole th... \$150 we raised at our party Friday

 **PAT** APR 2, 2001

### Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

A "thanks-for-going-out-of-your-way" pat to Sgt. Anderson of the JMU Police for being kind enough t... give me a jump start on Thursday

 **DART** JAN 25, 2001

### Neighbors, parties & student behavior

A "could-you-be-any-more-stupid?" dart to the drunk yelling, "Hey security guard, come arrest me, I... 19 and drunk!" outside the

 **PAT** APR 23, 2001

### Parking, towing & cars

A "thanks-for-saving-my-inebriated-butt-sanity-and-car" pat to the two awesome guys at the party in... Sunchase last Thursday night Thank

 **PAT** FEB 25, 2002

### Community service & mutual aid

A "thank you" pat to Delta Gamma and Kappa Pi for the huge box of art supplies they donated to the Mercy... House children's after-school

 **PAT** NOV 11, 2004

### Neighbors, parties & student behavior

A "thanks-from-the-community" pat to the JMU students who had a really cool haunted house for the... neighborhood children. From an Old

 **PAT** FEB 26, 2001

### Community service & mutual aid

A "many-thanks-for-your-efforts" pat to the Student Ambassadors and all the students who helped with... Operation Santa Claus. Sent in from

 **PAT** JAN 16, 2003

### Neighbors, parties & student behavior

A "thanks-for-showing-your-spirit" pat to the Harrisonburg High School cheerleaders for coming out to the... women's basketball game against

 **PAT** JAN 29, 2004

### Parking, towing & cars

A "thanks-for-proving-that-some-guys-at-JMU-do-exist" pat to the band that helped push our car afte... it got stuck in the snow and also to

 **PAT** SEP 27, 2001

### Community service & mutual aid

A "thank-you-so-very-much" pat to the Harrisonburg Rescue Squad and everyone involved with my incident... the other day. Sent in by a

 **PAT** FEB 18, 2002

### Civic identity, media & reputation

A "thank-you-for-supporting-a-great-cause" pat to the Harrisonburg community for comin... out to "The Vagina Monologues"

 **PAT** OCT 10, 2002

### Parking, towing & cars

An "I'm-singing-out-of-the-rain" pat to the girl who selflessly gave me a ride back to my apartment after I... locked my keys and my phone in my

Reading drawer remains large, readable, and touch-friendly.



 **DART · Oct 4, 2001**

Previous

22 of 72 in this view

Next

# Housing, landlords & apartment life

A "have-you-no-conscience" dart to the selfish jerks who walked into our apartment on Monday and stole the \$150 we raised at our party Friday night to send to the New York Fire Department. Sent in by four angry Sunchase residents who hope this comes back to you tenfold for stealing from a great cause.

|                             |                                    |                                                |                                                                           |                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DATE</b><br>Oct 4, 2001  | <b>TYPE</b><br>Dart                | <b>ERA</b><br>2000–2009                        | <b>PRIMARY TOPIC</b><br>Housing, landlords & apartment life               | <b>TOPIC TAGS</b><br>Police, public safety & city services, Housing, landlords & apartment life, Neighbors, parties & student behavior |
| <b>ENTITIES</b><br>Sunchase | <b>TARGET</b><br>the selfish jerks | <b>SENDER</b><br>four angry Sunchase residents | <b>SOURCE</b><br>The Breeze · PDF 491 to 500.pdf · Breeze p. 8 · PDF p. 5 | <b>RECORD ID</b><br>3150                                                                                                               |

Police, public safety & city services

Housing, landlords & apartment life

Neighbors, parties & student behavior

## Related by topic

**DART · MAR 19, 2001**  
**Housing, landlords & apartment life**  
A "you-guys-are-cheap-and-dumb" dart to an apartment complex in Harrisonburg for trying to char...

**DART · APR 23, 2001**  
**Housing, landlords & apartment life**  
A "do-your-freaking-job" dart to our apartment landlord for promising to fix our house eight mo...

**DART · APR 26, 2001**  
**Housing, landlords & apartment life**  
A "that"s-why-you-drain-it-for-the-winter" dart to the management of a certain apartment comple...

**DART · AUG 27, 2001**  
**Housing, landlords & apartment life**  
A "where"s-my-Simpsons" dart to NTC for not including Fox in their cable lineup for a certain a...